something real, out in the world, that somehow resembles the quantum. We just don't know what that means yet. And it's the job of physics to find out.

This is the great enterprise. This is what everyone in this sprawling tale fought for, in their ways: Bell with his scathing critic's pen, Bohm with his stubborn disregard for the status quo, Everett with his prankster's style. But their ideas aren't all that matters—their stories matter too. The history behind the physics can guide us in our pursuits, just as a new interpretation of a theory does. The path that led us here can give hints about the way forward. Demonstrating this, if nothing else, has been the aim of this book. I'll give the last word on the subject to someone far more qualified:

> So many people today—and even professional scientists—seem to me like somebody who has seen thousands of trees but has never seen a forest. A knowledge of the historic and philosophical background gives that kind of independence from prejudices of his generation from which most scientists are suffering. This independence created by philosophical insight is—in my opinion—the mark of distinction between a mere artisan or specialist and a real seeker after truth.
>
> **—Albert Einstein**